

INTERVIEWING EFFECTIVELY

A guide on winning the interview

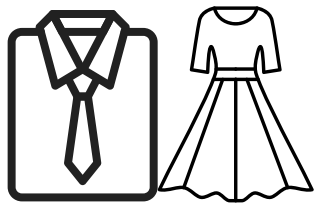
Interviewing can be stressful enough. Follow this step-by-step guide to help you fully prepare to rock that interview!

In this in-depth guide you will learn about what to do:

Before



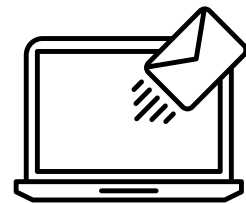
Day Of



During



After



Including additional tips to help you succeed!

Interviewing for a position, whether an internship or full-time job, can be a lengthy process. Often this begins with a screening interview, conducted virtually through a one-way video platform such as [HireVue](#) or as a 15-20 minute phone screen with a Human Resources/Recruitment professional. In some fields it is common for the first step to be the completion of an assessment to demonstrate your relevant skills. The next step will be an interview with a Hiring Manager or team connected to the role you are seeking. This may be followed by a third or fourth interview with additional team members including senior leadership. Other components of the interview may include giving a presentation, working through a case study (common for consulting), and additional skill assessments. The process can vary greatly by industry so be sure to do your research beforehand.



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Before the Interview

Research the employer. Gather as much information about the employer as you can. Visit company websites and look for information about them in the news and via LinkedIn.

Review your resume. Be prepared to elaborate on the material on your resume. Know yourself, your strengths, your weaknesses, and your career goals.

Practice your personal pitch. Often the first question is "Tell me about yourself." This should be 2-3 minutes briefly describing your background, qualifications, and why you are interested in the role.

Practice common interview questions. Use [Big Interview](#) and schedule a mock interview with a career advisor to prepare.

Day of the Interview

Be prepared. *If the interview is in-person*, be sure you know where you are going. Plan to arrive 15 minutes early. Bring extra copies of your resume on white or cream paper. *For a virtual interview*, be sure you have a quiet space free of distractions. Your background should be minimal. Test out the platform you will be interviewing on beforehand, along with your sound system. Be sure your computer is fully charged.

Attire. Dress for interviews varies by industry and therefore it is important to do your research. Business professional attire such as conservative suits, shirts, and ties, dresses or skirts with a blazer are typical for industries such as finance and accounting, while business casual attire (i.e. shirt without a tie and blouse with a skirt) is more common for industries such as tech. In general, clean nails, conservative make-up, and simple jewelry are appropriate. Avoid cologne or perfume. If wearing a kippa, choose solid dark colors. Even for virtual interviews, professional dress is recommended; you will feel more professional and likely present yourself more professionally. There is also always a chance you may need to get up during the virtual interview, so having a professional bottom as well as top (i.e. not sweatpants with a suit jacket) is important.



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During the Interview

Demonstrate professionalism. Be courteous to everyone. The interview starts the moment you walk into the building or join the virtual meeting. Never answer your phone or text during an interview. Your phone should be on silent or turned off and out of view. For virtual interviews, silence all notifications on your computer and close extra windows to avoid distraction.

Focus on the positive. Always remember to be positive and enthusiastic. Do not mention anything negative about yourself, your experiences, or any former colleagues or supervisors.

Sell yourself! You need to demonstrate to the interviewer why you are the best person for the position and why they should choose you over someone else.

Be specific. Give details and examples. General responses don't help you prove your case to the interviewer. Use the STAR or CAR method, outlined in our [Acing the Behavioral Interview Guide](#).

Never broach questions of salary, benefits, Shabbat, or holidays until you have been offered the job. You want to convey to the employer that you are sincerely interested in the job itself.

Make a positive last impression. Thank the interviewer, shake hands if in person, and inquire about next steps in the interview process. Let them know you are sincerely interested in the position.

Ask for a business card or email addresses for follow-up and for purposes of sending a thank-you note.

Ask thoughtful questions. Be sure to have 3-4 questions prepared to ask your interviewers at the end of the interview.



Examples of Questions ?

I noticed on your website that there has recently been a new initiative on_____. I'm wondering how that may affect this department or this specific role?

What opportunities for professional development are available at your company?

I recently read an article in the Wall Street Journal which predicted some of the trends of this industry. What is your take on the future growth of the organization?

Describe the work environment and organizational culture.

What is the overall structure of the department where the position is located?

What are your expectations for new hires?

What will be the biggest challenge facing the person taking this position?

How is an employee evaluated and promoted?

What do you enjoy about working for your firm?

After the Interview

Send thank you emails. Be sure to send a thank you email to everyone who interviewed you within 4-24 hours. Separate emails should be sent to each individual who participated in the interview. Send from your computer, not your phone.

Reflect and evaluate your performance. Each interview is a learning experience. Write down what you did well and what you could improve upon, along with questions you might want to prepare for in the future.

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